

STUDENT SAFETY AND DISCIPLINE ON BUSES

The safety of students is of great concern to the School Board, which provides for training of drivers, care and maintenance of equipment, regular inspections of equipment, review of all school sites and bus routes, assessing routes for walking to and from school, and other procedures to safeguard the students.

A. Emergency Plan and Safety Instruction

1. The Director of Transportation will develop a bus emergency action plan, in the form of a regulation, to be followed in the event of an emergency requiring or involving the transportation of students.

2. Student rider safety instruction shall be included in the elementary school curriculum, including demonstration and practices of safety procedures. At the Pre-K-1 grade levels, initial safety training shall be given during the first week of school in the classroom, and additional training shall be given on a periodic basis during the year.

3. Emergency exit drills, which include bus drivers, shall be practiced by all riders at least twice each year, with the first occurring during the first 30 instructional days and the second in the second semester. Summer session evacuation drills should be performed as needed by the bus drivers working with each school.

B. Student Safety and Discipline

1. The bus driver is responsible for the management of students on the bus. Students are expected to obey school rules and the verbal instructions of the driver.

2. Student safety, security, and comfort depend on appropriate behavior on Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) buses. Bus rider safety rules are included in the LCPS *Students Rights and Responsibilities*, which is distributed to all students and is posted on the LCPS website. The information shall include a request that a parent or their designee accompany young children to and from the bus stop. In no case shall a kindergarten student be unescorted or left at a bus stop unattended after school.

3. Consistent with Policy 8205 (Discipline Authority), the School Board affirms that, while riding the bus, students are considered on school property, and disciplinary infractions are handled in accordance with the LCPS *Student Rights and Responsibilities*. Students may be suspended from using school transportation services for violations of the LCPS *Student Rights and Responsibilities* or when the student endangers the health, safety, and welfare of other riders. Principals, or their designees, or the Director of Transportation are authorized to remove or deny transport to students who violate rules of student discipline, as outlined in the LCPS *Student Rights and Responsibilities*. In the event a student is not permitted to ride a school bus, their parent or guardian shall be responsible for providing transportation for the student to and from school.

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4. While Drivers are authorized to manage students while on their bus, including assigning seats, Drivers are not authorized to discipline students. Drivers shall report any student misconduct on school buses to the Principal. Recognizing the School Board's authority over students going to or returning from school, drivers shall also report any student misconduct at waiting stations, schools, or stops on the way to and from school to the Principal. The driver shall make similar reports to their Lead Driver to be placed into the Student Information System (SIS). Such initial discipline reports shall be placed into the Student Information System submitted to the Principal within two days of the incident. The Principal or designee shall take appropriate disciplinary action consistent with procedures for misconduct in schools (see, e.g., Policy 8210 (Introduction to Student Discipline)). Principals shall take appropriate, timely action upon receiving such reports.

5. Should it become necessary to correct student behavior, the driver shall have the authority to stop at the nearest and safest place and restore order before proceeding.

C. Management of Student Injuries and Accidents

LCPS will follow an effective process for handling and investigating accidents, so that all injured students and staff are cared for promptly, further injury is prevented, and correct and timely information is disseminated to all necessary parties.

D. Reporting of Student Injuries and Accidents

The Division of Transportation shall provide to the School Board a report of student injuries and accidents semi-annually.

[Former Policies 6-13, 6-24, 6-26]

Adopted: 5/22/18

Revised: 10/24/23

Leg Refs: Code of Virginia §§ [22.1-78](#), [22.1-180](#), [22.1-184](#), [46.2-919.1](#), [8 VAC 20-70-110](#), [8 VAC 20-70-360](#), [8VAC20-70-110](#)

Cross-Refs: Policy [8205](#), Discipline Authority; Policy [8210](#), Introduction to Student Discipline